

Walaqad Karamna

3 PARTIES · 86 VERS

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KIRAAM

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَٰنِ الرَّحِيمِ

وَلَقَدْ كَرَّمْنَا

Walaqad Karamna

وَجَّهْتُ وَجْهِي لِمَنْ تَكْرِيمُهُ بَانَا

✦ ✦ ✦

Œuvre de Cheikh Ahmadou Bamba Khadimou Rassoul

3 parties · 86 vers · mètre Rajas

English translation only

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PARTIE 1

Walaqad Karamna 1

1. I have turned my face to Him (Allah) whose honouring is manifest, in the month of the birth of him (the Prophet Muḥammad) through whom He sustained us upon the sea.

2. To God my thanksgiving, here, in the month of Rabīʿ (al-Awwal), for my undertaking of what He has chosen for me as a votive offering.

3. Already good has come from Him (Allah) who has no partner in sovereignty or in praise, in secret and in the open.

4. I have called upon the Kind (Al-Barr), the Most Merciful (Ar-Raḥīm): how excellent He who has honoured us on land and sea! How excellent is God, our Master!

5. By Your "Be!" (Kun) bring into being for me, on this day, an abundance of means, that I may raise pillars for the religion of God.

6. You have nurtured me: so grant me, this year, O my Everlasting Refuge (Aṣ-Ṣamad), perseverance (idmān) in good, felicity and a peaceful abode.

7 You have nurtured me after feeding me and giving me drink, since the Day of Tarwiya (the 8th of Dhū l-Ḥijja), when I wandered thirsty.

8 You have made me firm after hardship, You have led to me fine garments, widening all things after I had been held back, bereft.

9 Today I have addressed You in intimate prayer, O You who honoured me yesterday, and today You have led to me certainty and clear proof.

10 Turn the hearts of the Nazarenes (the Christian colonisers), O All-Powerful, to my aid, and subdue for me whoever is mighty or weak.

11 Since You are the One (Al-Wāḥid), the Subduer (Al-Qahhār), alone and without peer, subdue our enemies for me, so that my glad tidings may endure.

12 Yesterday You roused me with a warning in which I behold a marvel: You are the Originator (Al-Badīʿ), who never ceases to be the All-Merciful (Ar-Raḥmān).

13 Yesterday You made all easy for me: grant me today an abundance through which I may persevere, with excellence, in what pleases You.

14 You gave me refuge after my heart had been straitened by harm: so subdue for me, forever, jinn and men.

15 I have surrendered my face to You today, as a servant of him (Muḥammad) for whom I have become a Kaʿb and a Ḥassān (the Prophet's poets).

16 My ink has called for the fulfilment of my need, for the service of him (Muḥammad) whose glad tidings made us forget the enemies' harm:

17 Muḥammad, the best of God's creatures, our master; may He (Allah) whom I call upon for clarity send blessing upon him.

18 Turn to him (Muḥammad) forever a blessing joined with peace, to me the clarity of eloquence, and hold disobedience far from me.

19 You have carried me, O Lord, with honour, without hardship, over land and sea: increase my provision and my trust in You.

20 Grant me possession, this year, O Bestower (Al-Wahhāb), beyond my hope, and subdue for me hostility and whatever consoles the foe.

21 Grant me a lawful and pure provision, and preserve me from what You do not approve, in secret and in the open.

22 I have addressed my intimate prayer to the Kind, the Most Merciful, the Enricher (Allah); to Him I entrust my affair, and I hope, even now, for His help.

23 Accept my thanksgiving, widen my means here and hereafter, O Vast (Al-Wāsiʿ), O Enricher, who never cease to be the Supreme Judge (Ad-Dayyān).

24 Grant me, from Your cup, O Bestower, all my wishes together, until I am quenched with the water of the Unseen (al-ghayb).

25 Make me firm and widen my means, and let my sojourn (mukthī) be in abundance, like the Night of Destiny (Laylat al-Qadr), time after time.

26 In You make my sojourn a self-extinction (fanāʾ) without any slip, and through me bring to perfection eminent souls, and yet more eminent souls.

27 Make good easy for me, protect me and increase my right guidance, O Bestower of benefit, who never cease to be Kind and Bestower of favours (Al-Mannān).

28 Yours my heart and my body, and likewise my hand, O Guide (Al-Hādī), who never cease to be Lord and Most Tender (Al-Ḥannān).

29 Grant me without delay the meeting with the people of faith, that You may gladden whoever was grieving.

30 Since You are the Subduer (Al-Qāhir), the Compeller (Al-Jabbār), I have asked here that I need not contend with a tyrant or a sovereign.

PARTIE 2

Walaqad Karamna 2

31 Subdue the sovereigns for me, O Subduer (Al-Qahhār), forever; protect me and suffice me against scheming and against Satan.

32 I have hoped that You would protect me and help me with a mighty help, as I attain from You Your good pleasure.

33 You have kept me from the scheming of my enemies and those with them: so keep me forever from rancour and aggression.

34 Forgive my sins and grant me today what I ask, by Your "Be!" (Kun); and by it set right for me, forever, every state.

35 Grant me to part from every trait You are not pleased with, and erase from me, O All-Forgiving (Al-Ghaffār), whatever has disfigured me.

36 By the sanctity of the Chosen One (Muḥammad), whose Servant I have become, in verse and in prose, in rhymed prose and then in metre.

37 Accept the pilgrimage of my heart and keep me from error; erase what disgraces me and perfect me with what adorns.

38 O Lord, answer and bring to completion what I have intended at Ṭūbā (Touba), which by You and in You is built as an edifice.

39 On Saturday I turned my face, content, to Him (Allah) who, eternally, when He says "Be!", it is:

40 a Generous Lord, Guardian (Al-Ḥafīẓ), Vast, Everlasting Refuge (Aṣ-Ṣamad); and from Him I seek ease and a peaceful abode.

41 Increase my knowledge today with an increase that heralds for me the opening (fatḥ) and the outpouring (fayḍ), and subdue the jailer for me, for all time.

42 O Powerful, O Subduer, O Compeller (Al-Jabbār), O my sole aim: subdue for me him who takes wealth without right.

43 Today I have addressed You in intimate prayer, O Kind One: upon me towards Him lies a thanksgiving that puts ruby and coral to shame.

44 You are the Most High (Al-ʿAlī), the Immense (Al-ʿAẓīm), the Just (Al-ʿAdl), O my hope; You are the All-Knowing (Al-ʿAlīm), the Forbearing (Al-Ḥalīm), the Kind (Al-Barr), the All-Merciful (Ar-Raḥmān).

45 Grant me, by the sanctity of these Names, to subdue him who for long ages has striven against the people of Truth.

46 From You I have sought what You gave the righteous, so that by it they subdued the enemies unceasingly.

47 Grant me possession today, O Bestower (Al-Wahhāb), of what I ask, and keep me from the guile of him who, out of greed, has lied.

48 Today I have addressed You in intimate prayer, in need of You: so be for me the Enricher (Al-Mughnī), and today fling open the doors for me.

49 Open for me today, through the Chosen One (Al-Mukhtār, Muḥammad), our master, the doors of good that draw provision in its due time.

50 Be with me in generosity, felicity and mercy, and with glad tidings, O You whose favour is manifest.

51 Make my life good, without death (of the soul) or harm, and by Your grace let my sojourn, O Lord, be an offering of nearness.

52 Make easy all that I hope for and seek, until my eye is cooled and my heart rejoices.

53 O Lord, lead to me in the two abodes (this world and the Hereafter) every wish, and keep me forever from scheming and forsaking.

54 Make the Truth plain to me through an unveiling (kashf) that never leaves me, just as You unveiled clarity to the people of God (the Saints).

55 Turn the hearts of the enemies, all together, away from harming me, towards my help, and through me guide elders and youths.

56 Yesterday I left what I had sold (of myself to You), and it has passed: so change every time to good, and hold every disgrace far from me.

57 Turn towards me unveiling and fervour (at-taskhīn), without hardship, and keep me forever from ignorance and loss.

58 O Opener (Al-Fattāḥ), grant me an opening that shows marvels, O Best of guides, who have guided the untried and the bewildered.

59 I have been the guest of the Generous (Allah), who ever receives His guest with His "Be!"; and the time has come for me to be helped in my Ṭūbā (Touba).

60 I have been the guest of the Generous (Allah), who honoured me on land and on sea, when He led the Qur'an to me in outpouring.

PARTIE 3

Walaqad Karamna 3

61 To Him my words are addressed, on Saturday, in my homeland; and yesterday there appeared to me what has become a clear proof.

62 Yesterday You roused me: increase the outpouring (fayḍ) and the gnosis (maʿrifa), and forever, O Lord, illumine minds through me.

63 Make my return to my abode our happiness, and on the Day the creatures are gathered keep us from the fires (of Hell).

64 Grant me, by Your grace, to be forever a joy to the Muslims, and make our glad tidings everlasting in You.

65 Grant me possession today of something that never leaves me: glad tidings that in the two abodes stay close beside me.

66 I praise You with virgin praises, never spoken before, that I bring from the outpourings that pour down abundant as rains.

67 Lead to me endlessly openings (futūḥ) through which I may be glad tidings for whoever has embraced the guidance of Islam.

68 You are the All-Knowing (Al-ʿAlīm), who taught Your company that by which, through Your folding of distances (ṭayy), they outstripped one field after another.

69 Bring into being for me, today, an ease that makes it easy for me to recover, by Your bringing into being, what had been lost.

70 Make my heart firm, make my speech upright, and keep me from error of tongue, by annihilating what had been present (in the soul).

71 Make easy for me today, O Bestower (Al-Wahhāb), all that I hope for, and grant me precedence and pre-eminence.

72 You nurtured me, O Lord, in exile among enemies, until the time of my return to the homeland had come.

73 Grant Your humble servant possession of what he chooses from You, without scheming or deprivation, and make him docile and submissive.

74 Grant him possession, O Lord, out of generosity, of what surpasses every wish, O You who satisfy whoever has suffered hunger.

75 He has addressed You in intimate prayer, hoping You will not disappoint him: spare me, on the Day the creatures are raised, (the trial of) the Balance.

76 Frustrate forever the hope of whoever loathes him, since the year he was held back (in exile), when the Pilgrimage was his balance.

77 For him (Your servant) decree this year a reward without interruption, in all that he intends, for You, of adorning guidance.

78 Turn the hearts of all the enemies to his support, on land and on sea, O You who, if You will, make them yield.

79 He has addressed You in intimate prayer, hoping for what he longed for without delay, O Best of those to whom one turns, even the most impatient.

80 You are the Restorer (Al-Muʿīd), through whom I gain permanence in this world and the next: so grant me the return, O our Master.

81 I have left what was mine, by selling it, seeking what is with Him (Allah) who now fulfils my need.

82 O Opener (Al-Fattāḥ), Bestower (Al-Wahhāb), O Provider (Ar-Razzāq), O my King: open for me, give to me and provide for me by Your "Be!", with gentleness.

83 Remove my hardship without delay with gladness and aid, that I may raise pillars for the religion of God.

84 Make easy my return to Ṭūbā (Touba), protect me and keep me from the harm of creatures, and make my dwelling there pleasant for me.

85 Yours are the heaven, the earths and the air, without any partner: subdue for me whoever manifestly associates (others with You).

86 Answer, and pour forth blessing and peace upon the Support (As-Sanad), Muḥammad; and grant me an eminent and manifest gift.

وَلَقَدْ كَرَّمْنَا

Walaqad Karamna

وَجَّهْتُ وَجْهِي لِمَنْ تَكْرِيمُهُ بَانَا ۞
فِي شَهْرِ مَوْلِدِ مَنْ فِي الْبَحْرِ رَبَّانَا

« J'ai tourné mon visage vers Celui (Allah) dont l'honneur accordé est manifeste, au mois de la naissance de celui (le Prophète Muḥammad) par qui sur la mer Il nous a gardés. »

« Walaqad Karamna » est un khassida de Cheikh Ahmadou Bamba Khadimou Rassoul, guide spirituel et fondateur de Touba. Cette édition réunit ses 86 vers, répartis en 3 parties, en arabe vocalisé, avec leur translittération et leur traduction.

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